MIL-G-36724A
20 September 1978
SUPERSEDING
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2 December 1970

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

GLOVE, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, RUBBER LATEX, STERILE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, disposable, impermeable, light-weight, seamless rubber latex glove which fits either hand. The glove shall be suitable for medical use in examinations and diagnostic and therapeutic procedures by physicians, nurses, and para-medical personnel.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

FSC 6515

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MILITARY

MIL-S-36586 - Sterilization Test Strip Set, Bacterial Spore.

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 601 - Rubber: Testing and Sampling.

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of specifications, standards and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following document forms a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bid or request for proposal shall apply.

U.S. PHARMACOPEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (USP)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042.)

(Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Materials.

3.1.1 Gloves. The gloves shall be fabricated from natural rubber latex, free from coloring and fillers.

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3.1.2 Dusting powder. Gloves shall be uniformly prepowdered with vegetable powder that shall be biologically absorbable and non-toxic. The minimum amount of powder is preferred. Powder shall be in accordance with the USP for Absorbable Dusting Powder.

3.2 Style and design. The patient examining and treatment glove shall be designed to fit either hand. Each glove shall have five fingers and be suitable for performing patient examinations and treatments. The gloves shall be constructed to provide maximum tactility in use, and shall have well-fitting fingers that permit maximum freedom of movement. The palm section shall be of sufficient width to permit comfortable flexing of the hands. The wrists shall be tapered or constricted to conform and adhere to wearer's wrist and forearm to minimize "roll down". Beads or bands at the cuff edge are acceptable. The gloves shall be packaged in such a manner that they can be readily dispensed.

3.2.1 Dimensions. Dimensions of the gloves shall be as indicated in table I and as specified in 4.5.1.

TABLE I. Dimensions.

Characteristic	Inches
Overall length	9-1/2 minimum
Flat width at wrist	3-3/8 ± 1/8 1/
Flat width of palm at base of thumb	3-13/16 ± 1/4
Length of thumb	2-1/4
Length of little finger	2-1/8
Length of middle finger	3-3/16
Length of index finger	2-5/8
Length of ring finger	2-15/16
Flat width of thumb at base	1-7/16
Flat width of thumb 3/4 inch below tip	1-1/4
Flat width of forefinger	1-7/16
Flat width of forefinger 3/4 inch below tip	1-1/8
Flat width of ring finger at base	1-1/4
Flat width of ring finger 3/4 inch below tip	1-1/8
Flat width of middle finger	1-7/16
Flat width of middle finger 3/4 inch below tip	1-3/16
Flat width of little finger at base	1-1/8
Flat width of little finger 3/4 inch below tip	1
Thickness at finger tip	.006 + .0015, - .0005
Thickness at cuff, 1" below bead	.004 + .0025, - .0005
Thickness at palm, center	.005 ± .001
Thickness at any point	.003 minimum

1/ Unless otherwise stated, all lengths and flat widths which follow have ± 1/8 inch tolerance.

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Large Extra Large Small Medium

3.2.2 Physical requirements. The gloves shall comply with the physical requirements contained in table II. Tests shall be conducted as specified in 4.5.2.

TABLE II. Physical requirements.

Characteristic	Values
Tensile strength in pounds per square inch (psi)	3500 min.
Ultimate elongation in percentage	700 min.
Specific gravity	0.95 ± .02 .05

3.2.3 Dispensability. The glove shall be able to be removed easily from its package and, upon removal, shall show no evidence of sticking to other gloves. The glove shall be wrapped in an inner wrapper which in turn is enclosed in an outer wrapper. The outer wrapper shall be capable of being opened without endangering the sterility of its contents when tested as specified in 4.5.5.

3.3 Finish. The gloves shall have a uniform smooth finish which is free from holes, visible surface or embedded particles, tackiness, bloom, strings, and other imperfections.

3.4 Freedom from pinholes. The glove shall be supplied free of pinholes as shown by the absence of leakage when tested as specified in 4.5.4.

3.5 Sterility. The entire contents of the outer wrapper shall be sterile. The gloves shall comply with requirements for sterility when tested with a biological indicator as specified in 4.5.3.

3.5.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item identification.
b. National Stock Number (NSN).
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc.).
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated paper spore strip or carrier, inoculated product, or inoculated simulated product).

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shall not exceed the acceptance criteria established herein.

i. Test organism(s) and population density used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates of tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of a laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

When inspection is made at destination, the certificate of sterility shall be submitted by the contractor to the Defense Personnel Support Center, Directorate of Medical Materiel, Technical Operations Division, ATTN: DPSC-ATQ, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, and a copy forwarded with each shipment to the consignee. When inspection is made at source, certificate of sterility shall be furnished to the cognizant Government Quality Assurance Representative for submission to the procuring activity.

3.5.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and sterilized simultaneously in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number and date of sterilization as specified in 5.3.2. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the pertinent manufacturing lot(s).

3.6 Individual package. The completed, individual package shall consist of a glove in an inner wrapper, enclosed in turn in an outer sealed wrapper. The outer wrapper shall maintain the sterility of the inner packaging and its contents. Outer wrapper shall permit ready dispensing of the contents by sterile techniques. Closure of the outer wrapper shall be accomplished by heat or cold sealing. The sealed outer wrapper shall be designed to strip cleanly, without leaving jagged edges of paper extending into the sterilized field more than 5/16 inch, or otherwise contaminating the contents.

3.6.1 Outer wrapper. The outer wrapper shall be marked to identify contents, lot number, NSN and the legends: "STERILE", "DISPOSABLE" and "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED" or similar statement. In addition, marking shall include the glove size, name of manufacturer, date of packaging by month and year (e.g., 7/70), and the method of sterilization (G-Gas, R-Radiation, S-Steam, D-Dry Heat Sterilization). The methods of sterilization shall be shown following the date packed. Example: "9/70-G". Final sterilization shall be on or after indicated packaging date.

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3.6.2 Instructions. Each outer wrapper shall be marked with instructions describing the proper technique for dispensing the sterile contents from the outer wrapper without compromising the sterility of the contents.

3.7 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. Gloves shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or impair their serviceability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual and auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table III. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one glove.

TABLE III. Sampling for examination.

Type of defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	I	1.5
Minor	I	2.5

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4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in table IV. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one glove. Where possible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

TABLE IV. Sampling for tests.

Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Dimensions	3.2.1	4.4.1	S-2	2.5
Physical requirements	3.2.2	4.4.2	S-2	2.5
Dispensability	3.2.3	4.4.5	S-2	2.5
Freedom from pinholes	3.4	4.4.4	S-2	2.5
Sterility	3.5	4.4.3	S-3	*

* Acceptance number shall be zero.

4.3 Examination. The gloves shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables III and V. Inspection, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table V. Any glove in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and, if the number of defective gloves in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

TABLE V. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Major	
101	Tears present.
102	Large holes present.
103	Large, embedded, grit-like particles.
104	Tackiness.
105	Surfaces not uniform or smooth.
106	Gloves are not free from foreign matter.
Minor	
201	Excessive blisters that would interfere with accepted professional use (clusters of small blisters as contrasted with large, open blisters).
202	Bloom, strings, bleeding, or other imperfections.
203	Excessive amount of dusting powder present.

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4.4 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the unit package, intermediate package, packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. The samples and specimens shall be kept in light-tight containers, except while being inspected, prepared or measured.

4.5.1 Dimensions. Dimensions shall be measured in accordance with the FED. TEST METHOD STD. NO. 601 indicated in table VI.

TABLE VI. Test methods.

Requirement	Test Method No.
Thickness	2011 or 2031
Length	2411
Tensile stress	4131 1/
Tensile strength	4111 1/
Ultimate elongation	4121 1/
Specific gravity	14011 or 14021

1/ Use dumbbell specimen cut with die III of Figure 4111.

4.5.3 Sterility test. The gloves shall be tested for sterility in accordance with the method specified in the USP using inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). Product containing a biological indicator shall be marked or labeled so that it clearly differentiates from the product intended for distribution. The incubation medium and minimum time in each case shall be soybean casein digest for 7 days for inoculated product, inoculated simulated product, or paper spore strip (carrier). The incubation temperature shall be as indicated in 4.5.3.1. The minimum number of test units, regardless of lot size, shall be 10, except for inoculated carrier which shall be 20 for Type I Sterilization and 30 for Type II Sterilization, including inoculated carrier and product test units. The inspection level shall be as indicated in table IV.

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4.5.3.1 Inoculated product or simulated product. For each type of sterilization, the organism used shall be as listed below:

Type of Sterilization	Organism	Incubation Temperature
Steam	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
Dry Heat	B. stearothermophilus	55° - 65°C
	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Gas	B. subtilis var. niger (or globigii)	30° - 35°C
Radiation	B. pumilus	30° - 35°C

The number of viable cells shall be sufficient to provide assurance that the product has been sterilized.

4.5.3.2 Inoculated carrier. Inoculated carriers (paper spore strips), if used, shall be in accordance with MIL-S-36586. Other paper carriers shall be inoculated to be of equivalent resistance. The method of incubation and number of test units shall be as indicated in 4.5.3 and 4.5.3.1. The method of sterilization will control the one organism in the spore strip to be tested for, as shown in 4.5.3.1.

When an inoculated carrier is chosen, product sample must also be tested as required by the USP.

4.5.3.3 Alternate method. Suppliers conducting sterility tests or designating lots in a manner other than that indicated herein shall submit proof that the alternate method provides equal assurance concerning the sterility of the product. However, all sterility tests shall be conducted using biological indicators. Requests for approval of any alternate method of testing for sterility shall be made to the Contracting Officer, and approval obtained before employment of the alternate method on a government contract.

4.5.3.4 Product testing. Testing for sterility of the product after receipt by the Government shall be without a biological indicator and in accordance with the USP.

4.5.4 Pinhole test. Gloves shall be inflated with air to a pressure of 20 millimeters of mercury while immersed in water at 70° to 75°F (21° to 24°C) to observe pinholes. The gloves shall be manipulated so that the hand of the tester does not remain on one spot of the glove and thus obscure possible leakage.

4.5.5 Dispensability test. The outer wrapper shall be opened, and the gloves removed in accordance with instructions provided (see 3.6.2).

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5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One package containing fifty individually packaged gloves constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Level A.

5.1.2.1 Unit package. Fifty gloves, individually packaged as specified in 3.6, shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-566 or PPP-B-676. The box may be a dispenser type container of an appropriate size and design. Closure of the boxes shall be adequate to prevent opening under normal handling.

5.1.3 Level C. Gloves shall be clean, dry, and individually packaged sterile. Fifty individually packaged gloves shall be further packaged in a manner that will afford adequate protection against deterioration and physical damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A. Twenty unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure, strapping and waterproofing shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twenty unit packages shall be packed in a shipping container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The packaged gloves shall be packed in shipping containers in a manner that will afford adequate protection against damage during direct shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. These packs shall conform to the carrier's rules and regulations.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Individual package. Each individual package shall be marked as specified in 3.6.

5.3.2 Unit package. Each unit package shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129. Lot or control number, contract or purchase order number shall be shown. The method of sterilization, as specified in 3.6.1, shall be shown following the level of packaging and date of packaging. Example: "A 8/70-G".

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5.3.3 Shipping container. Shipping containers shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129. The lot or control number and method of sterilization, as specified in 5.3.2, shall be shown.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents shall specify the following:

a. Title, number and date of this specification.
b. Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
c. Applicable NSN.

6.2 This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-181-7449	GLOVE, PATIENT EXAMINING AND TREATMENT, Rubber, Latex, Sterile, 50s.

6.3 This specification is intended to cover a type that is normally procured to meet military requirements. It does not include all types, sizes or grades as indicated by the title nor all types which are commercially available.

6.4 The medical literature has indicated the danger of dusting powder causing granuloma. It is therefore good practice to prevent the introduction of dusting powder into wound or operational sites. This is done by wiping thoroughly after donning with a sterile wet sponge or sterile, wet towel. Manufacturers may properly print such advice on the outer wrapper of each glove.

6.5 Changes from previous issue. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue, due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Review activity:
DOD-MB

Preparing activity:
DLA-DM

Project No. 6515-2077

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DPSC - ATT
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Philadelphia, Pa. 19101

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DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
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NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS

CONTRACT NUMBER

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A
☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

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